

One actor, six decades, one conclave: made from words and his own interview

Armin Mueller-Stahl, with his consent, in two generated tests and two looks. No film, broadcast or press image entered any generation; the only pictures of him were five stills from FFP's own 2026 interview. Every prompt was shown to the producer before it fired; every prediction was written before the credit was spent and graded after; every rejected take is kept.



Source · interview still, 95, FFP's own



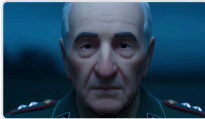
Sheet at 77 · edited from the anchor; passed the identity gate



A, photoreal · the father at the wheel, seventies



A, photoreal · the church prince, two-thousands



A, 3D style · same shot list, matte render; insignia invented



B, photoreal · the conclave; only he carries the face



B, photoreal · white smoke, rising pull-back over Rome



What the sheet buys. Left: the control, no picture of him, his face in words only. Middle: the same shot with the sheets bound. Right: the interview still. The producer, blind to the labels: the left one is not him. Words buy the type; the sheet buys the likeness.



B, 3D style · the same text, the 3D sheets bound, 288 credits. Clearly non-photoreal and still one character.

SEVEN TAKES, 2,274 CREDITS

RUN	WHAT	CR	SHOTS	RESULT
A-1 t1	photoreal montage, 30 s, 7 refs	450	13/13	every motif present; ages read 65 to 85; cap and uniform insignia invented
A-1 t2	same, car from the front (producer's change)	360	13/13	car as asked; insignia in two shots; door shot in colour
A-2	3D style, 2 refs	360	13/13	the look holds throughout; a licence plate and a maker badge invented on the car
B-1 t1	photoreal conclave, 20 s	240	5/5	every written gate held; every cardinal wore his face (a gate nobody had written)
B-1 t2	face rule in words, cinematic wides, 24 s	288	5/5	only he carries the face; two aerial moves as written; smoke from the dome, not a chimney
B-2	3D conclave, 24 s	288	5/5	clearly 3D; the others share a family likeness; smoke from the dome again
B-0	control: no reference, face in words	288	5/5	a consistent old cardinal who is not him (producer, blind)

PREDICTIONS: 19 HELD, 4 FAILED, 2 PARTIAL

WRITTEN BEFORE SPENDING	ODDS	VERDICT
All 13 montage shots present, first take	0.30	held, under-confident
Cost 270 per 30 s run	0.90	360 charged; rate moved
Four age sheets pass first time	0.35	1, 2, 3, 3 takes
Ages readable per decade (added)	-	failed twice
No insignia (added)	-	failed; fix held on B
The stage dims as written	0.70	dims, front-loaded
Second pass fixes the face leak	0.55	held
Control: a blind reviewer cannot tell it is him	0.75	held
Identity across six ages, photoreal (A-1)	0.45	him from the sixties on; not in the young shots
One recognisable character in 3D (A-2)	0.50	held

RULES THAT CAME OUT, NOW IN EVERY PROMPT

- Only he has the bound face; every other figure of the same type gets a different face in words, or the sheet leaks onto all of them.
- Itemise absent decoration on formal dress: no medals, orders, braid, epaulettes, badges, lettering.
- A real face ages 15 to 20 years per step, each from the previous; one 45-year jump destroyed it.
- Age in words does not bind to a real face in video; he read 65 to 85 in every montage shot.
- The strong image model renders him only at the bound picture's age and only with a consent sentence; the lighter one does every age shift.
- Grade words first in a shot with no face; name absent plates and badges on vehicles; the dim is the action.

ALL IMAGES AND VIDEOS IN THIS STUDY WERE CREATED FROM A SINGLE PICTURE OF ARMIN MUELLER-STAHLE AT 95, TAKEN IN OUR 2026 INTERVIEW. THIS IS A TEST, NOT THE FINAL RESULT. THREE MORE IMAGES (HIM YOUNG, MIDDLE-AGED AND OLDER) STILL HAVE TO BE CREATED.

Before anything is published: the written consent is pending (the consent sentence in the prompts rests on the producer's word); training a model of his face (version C) is deferred by the producer, the consent covers it, to be run if ORF wants it; the real St. Peter's rendered from the words "dome and square", allowed by the brief; two film and book images of him young were looked at and never bound.

Spend: 2,274 video credits over eight charges (draft 90, full runs 240 to 360), stills near-free, no model trained. Ledgers, prompts as fired, contact sheets and every rejected take: empirica-videogen/out/gh-A1, gh-A2, gh-B · stills: empirica-imagegen/out/goldener-herbst · shot lists, gates, predictions: empirica-storyboard/scenes/goldener-herbst · provenance rows: ffp-archive C_Quellenliste.